3. Just ten days after Berlin was split, Ulbricht and Honecker were beaming on Stalinalle reviewing a march-past of factory fighting squads, an event broadcast on domestic radio, which described the scene: ‘Detachments of 100 men, one after another, are now forming for the march-past in the direction of the clubhouse of the building workers. Flying above their heads are the red flags of the working class, under whose symbol they have mounted guard. Accompanied by armoured cars and trucks, on which heavy machine guns and anti-aircraft searchlights are mounted, they are now marching through the first socialist street of Berlin.’ FBISFRB-61-164 East Berlin domestic service 1545 GMT 24 August 1961

4. Die Fischer Chronik Deutschland . p.292

5. Neue Zeit . 17 September 1961

6. Fischer. p.318

7. New York Times . 11 October 1963

8. Birmingham Daily Post . 15 January 1963

9. Honecker Cross Examined . p.112.

10. Birmingham Daily Post . 4 October 1963

11. ‘Was der BND über Erich Honecker wusste’. Sachsische Zeitung, 24 November 2012

12. Telegraf 19 August 1963. FBIS-FRB-63-161

13. GDR post office workers were responsible for processing the permit applications. Although they were state employees, they did not represent East German public authorities like police or customs officials. As a result, the Federal Republic viewed the border pass agreement as an administrative agreement that did not signify recognition of the GDR. The SED regime, on the other hand, did everything it could to give the agreement the character of an international treaty. A total of four border pass agreements were negotiated up until 1966.